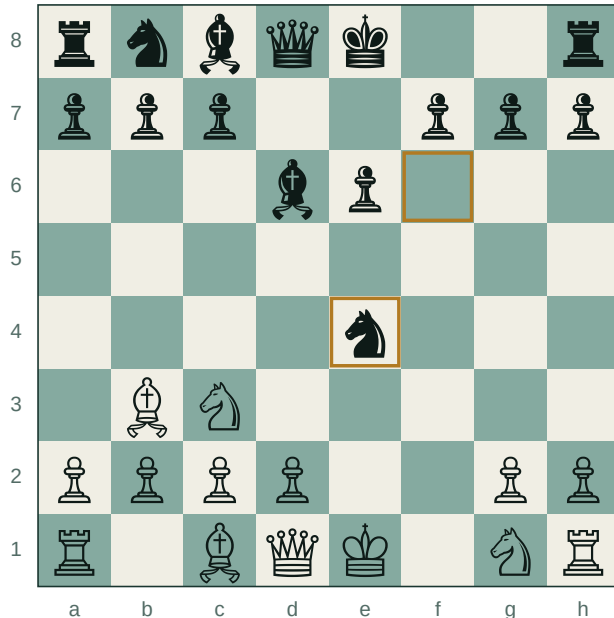


Active defensive resources: White, move 7

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 6...Nxe4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

7. Nxe4 Qh4+ 8. Nf2

7.Nxe4 The knight captures the knight on e4. Recorded reply: **7...Qh4+**.

8.Nf2 The knight moves from e4 to f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 37 / Black 35 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.